

Advanced Topics

Whew! We've come a long way from learning the basic phonetic alphabet to covering almost all the grammar you're going to need for daily conversations. But wait, we're not finished yet! In fact, things are going to get even more challenging and interesting because, especially toward the latter part of this section, we are going to learn grammar that only *might* come in handy. In my experience, the most useful things are easiest to learn as they come up again and again. However, in order to completely master a language, we also must work hard to conquer the bigger area of things that don't come up very often and yet every native Japanese speaker instinctively understands. Believe it or not, even the more obscure grammar *will* come up eventually leaving you wondering what it's supposed to mean. That's why *I* bothered to learn them at least.

Formal Expressions

What do you mean by formal expressions?

So far we have learned casual, polite, and honorific/humble types of languages. So what do I mean by formal expressions? I think we are all aware of the type of language I am talking about. We hear it in speeches, read it in reports, and see it on documentaries. While discussing good writing style is beyond the scope of this guide, we will go over some of the grammar that you will commonly find in this type of language. Which is not to say that it won't appear in regular everyday speech. (Because it does.)

Using 「である」 for formal state-of-being

Vocabulary

1. 我輩【わが・はい】 - I; we
2. 猫【ねこ】 - cat
3. 夏目【なつ・め】 - Natsume (last name)
4. 漱石【そう・せき】 - Souseki (first name)
5. お任せ【お・まか・せ】 - leaving a decision to someone else
6. 表示【ひょう・じ】 - display
7. 混合物【こん・ごう・ぶつ】 - mixture, amalgam
8. 種類【しゅ・るい】 - type, kind, category
9. 以上【い・じょう】 - greater or equal
10. 純物質【じゅん・ぶつ・しつ】 - pure material
11. 混じりあう【ま・じりあう】 (u-verb) - to mix together
12. 物質【ぶつ・しつ】 - pure material
13. 何【なに / なん】 - what

We have already learned how to speak with your friends in casual speech, your superiors in polite speech, and your customers in honorific / humble speech. We've learned 「だ」、「です」、and 「でございます」 to express a state-of-being for these different levels of politeness. There is one more type of state-of-being that is primarily used to state facts in a neutral, official sounding manner - 「である」. Just like the others, you tack 「である」 on to the adjective or noun that represents the state.

Examples

- 吾輩は猫である

I am a cat. (This is the title of a famous novel by 夏目漱石)

Since I'm too lazy to look up facts, let's trot on over to the Japanese version of [Wikipedia](#) and look at some random articles by clicking on 「おまかせ表示」.

- 混合物(こんごうぶつ, mixture)とは、2種類以上の純物質が混じりあっている物質である。([Wikipedia - 混合物](#), July 2004)

An amalgam is a mixture of two or more pure materials.

To give you an idea of how changing the 「である」 changes the tone, I've included some fake content around that sentence.

1. 混合物は何？
混合物は、2種類以上の純物質が混じりあっている物質だ。
2. 混合物は何ですか？
混合物は、2種類以上の純物質が混じりあっている物質です。
3. 混合物は何でしょうか。

混合物は、2種類以上の純物質が混じりあっている物質でございます。

4. 混合物とは？

混合物は、2種類以上の純物質が混じりあっている物質である。

Negative of 「である」

Vocabulary

1. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
2. それ - that
3. 不公平 【ふ・こう・へい】 - unfair
4. 言語 【げん・ご】 - language
5. 簡単 【かん・たん】 (na-adj) - simple
6. マスター - master
7. する (exception) - to do
8. こと - event, matter
9. 出来る 【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
10. 学生 【がく・せい】 - student

Because the negative of 「ある」 is 「ない」, you might expect the opposite of 「である」 to be 「でない」. However, for some reason I'm not aware of, you need to insert the topic particle before 「ない」 to get 「ではない」.

Examples

1. それは不公平ではないでしょうか。
Wouldn't you consider that to be unfair?
2. 言語は簡単にマスターできることではない。
Language is not something that can be mastered easily.

Using 「である」 to sound official

Attach 「である」 to the verb or adjective that the state-of-being applies to.

Example: 学生 → 学生である

For the negative, attach 「ではない」 to the verb or adjective that the state-of-being applies to.

Example: 学生 → 学生ではない

For the past tense state-of-being, apply the regular past tenses of 「ある」

Complete conjugation chart for 「である」

Positive		Negative	
学生 <u>である</u>	is student	学生 <u>ではない</u>	is not student
学生 <u>であった</u>	was student	学生 <u>ではなかった</u>	was not student

Sequential relative clauses in formal language

Vocabulary

1. 花火 【はな・び】 - fireworks
2. 火薬 【か・やく】 - gunpowder
3. 金属 【きん・ぞく】 - metal
4. 粉末 【ふん・まつ】 - fine powder
5. 混ぜる 【ま・ぜる】 (ru-verb) - to mix
6. 物 【もの】 - object
7. 火 【ひ】 - flame, light
8. 付ける 【つ・ける】 (ru-verb) - to attach
9. 燃焼時 【ねん・しょう・じ】 - at time of combustion
10. 火花 【ひ・ばな】 - spark
11. 楽しむ 【たの・しむ】 (u-verb) - to enjoy
12. ため - for the sake/benefit of
13. 企業内 【き・ぎょう・ない】 - company-internal
14. 顧客 【こ・きゃく】 - customer, client
15. データ - data
16. 利用 【り・よう】 - usage
17. する (exception) - to do
18. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
19. 行方 【ゆく・え】 - whereabouts
20. 調べる 【しら・べる】 (ru-verb) - to investigate
21. こと - event, matter
22. 出来る 【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
23. 封筒 【ふう・とう】 - envelope
24. 写真 【しゃ・しん】 - photograph
25. 数枚 【すう・まい】 - several sheets (flat objects)
26. 入る 【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter
27. 手紙 【て・がみ】 - letter
28. 添える 【そ・える】 (ru-verb) - to garnish; to accompany (as a card does a gift)
29. この - this (abbr. of これの)
30. ファイル - file
31. パスワード - password
32. 設定 【せつ・てい】 - setting
33. 開く 【ひら・く】 (u-verb) - to open
34. ～際 【～さい】 - on the occasion of
35. それ - that
36. 入力 【にゅう・りょく】 - input
37. 必要 【ひつ・よう】 - necessity
38. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)

In the Compound Sentence lesson, we learned how to use the te-form of verbs to express multiples sequential actions in one sentence. This practice, however, is used only in regular everyday speech.

Formal speeches, narration, and written publications employ the verb stem instead of the te-form to describe sequential actions. Particularly, newspaper articles, in the interest of brevity, always prefer verb stems to the te-form.

Examples

1. 花火 (はなび) は、火薬と金属の粉末を混ぜたものに火を付け、燃焼時の火花を楽しむためのもの。
([Wikipedia - 花火](#), August 2004)
Fireworks are for the enjoyment of sparks created from combustion created by lighting up a mixture of gunpowder and metal powder.
2. 企業内の顧客データを利用し、彼の行方を調べることが出来た。
Was able to investigate his whereabouts using the company's internal customer data.

For the 「～ている」 forms, the stem becomes 「～てい」 but because that doesn't fit very well into the middle of a sentence, it is common to use the humble form of 「いる」 which you will remember is 「おる」. This is simply so you can employ 「おり」 to connect relative clauses instead of just 「い」. It has nothing to do with the humble aspect of 「おる」

1. 封筒には写真が数枚入っており、手紙が添えられていた。
Several photos were inside the envelope, and a letter was attached.
2. このファイルにはパスワードが設定されており、開く際にはそれを入力する必要がある。
A password has been set on this file, and it needs to be entered when opening.

Things that should be a certain way

In this lesson, we'll learn how to express the way things are supposed depending on what we mean by "supposed". While the first two grammar points 「はず」 and 「べき」 come up often and are quite useful, you'll rarely ever encounter 「べく」 or 「べからず」. You can safely skip those lessons unless you are studying for the JLPT.

Using 「はず」 to describe an expectation

Vocabulary

1. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
2. 日曜日 【にち・よう・び】 - Sunday
3. 可能 【か・のう】 (na-adj) - possible
4. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
5. 帰る 【かえ・る】 (u-verb) - to go home
6. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
7. 漫画 【まん・が】 - comic book
8. マニア - mania
9. これ - this
10. ～ら - pluralizing suffix
11. もう - already
12. 全部 【ぜん・ぶ】 - everything
13. 読む 【よ・む】 (u-verb) - to read
14. この - this (abbr. of これの)
15. 料理 【りょう・り】 - cooking; cuisine; dish
16. 焦げる 【こ・げる】 (ru-verb) - to burn, to be burned
17. まずい (i-adj) - unpleasant
18. 色々 【いろ・いろ】 (na-adj) - various
19. 予定 【よ・てい】 - plans, arrangement
20. する (exception) - to do
21. 今年 【こ・とし】 - this year
22. 楽しい 【たの・しい】 (i-adj) - fun
23. クリスマス - Christmas
24. そう - (things are) that way
25. 簡単 【かん・たん】 (na-adj) - simple
26. 直す 【なお・す】 (u-verb) - to correct, to fix
27. 打合せ 【うち・あわ・せ】 - meeting
28. 毎週 【まい・しゅう】 - every week
29. ～時 【～じ】 - counter for hours
30. 始まる 【はじ・まる】 (u-verb) - to begin

The first grammar we will learn is 「はず」, which is used to express something that was or is supposed to be. You can treat 「はず」 just like a regular noun as it is usually attached to the adjective or verb that is supposed to be or supposed to happen.

The only thing to be careful about here is expressing an expectation of something *not* happening. To do this, you must use the negative existence verb 「ない」 to say that such an expectation does not exist. This might be in the form of 「～はずがない」 or 「～はずはない」 depending on which particle you want to use. The negative conjugation 「はずじゃない」 is really only used when you want to confirm in a positive sense such as 「～はずじゃないか？」.

Using 「はず」 to describe an expectation

Use 「はず」 just like a regular noun to modify the expected thing

Examples

1. 日曜日のはず (noun)
2. 可能なはず (na-adjective)
3. おいしいはず (i-adjective)
4. 帰るはず (verb)

For the case where you expect the negative, use the 「ない」 verb for nonexistence

Example: 帰るはず → 帰るはずがない

Examples

1. 彼は漫画マニアだから、これらをもう全部読んだはずだよ。
He has a mania for comic book(s) so I expect he read all these already.
2. この料理はおいしいはずだったが、焦げちゃって、まずくなった。
This dish was expected to be tasty but it burned and became distasteful.
3. 色々予定してあるから、今年は楽しいクリスマスのはず。
Because various things have been planned out, I expect a fun Christmas this year.
4. そう簡単に直せるはずがないよ。
It's not supposed to be that easy to fix.
5. 打合せは毎週2時から始まるはずじゃないですか？
This meeting is supposed to start every week at 2 o'clock, isn't it?

Here are [more examples](#) from the WWWJDIC. You may also want to check out the [jeKai entry](#).

Using 「べき」 to describe actions one should do

Vocabulary

1. 絶対【ぜっ・たい】(na-adj) - absolutely, unconditionally
2. ある(u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
3. 強い【つよ・い】(i-adj) - strong
4. 推奨【すい・しょう】 - recommendation
5. する(exception) - to do
6. 擦る【す・る】(u-verb) - to rub
7. 行う【おこな・う】(u-verb) - to conduct, to carry out
8. 何【なに / なん】 - what
9. 買う【か・う】(u-verb) - to buy
10. 前【まえ】 - front; before
11. 本当【ほん・とう】 - real
12. 必要【ひつ・よう】 - necessity
13. どう - how
14. いい(i-adj) - good
15. 考える【かんが・える】(ru-verb) - to think
16. 例え【たと・え】 - example
17. 国【くに】 - country
18. 国民【こく・みん】 - people, citizen
19. 騙す【だま・す】(u-verb) - to trick, to cheat, to deceive
20. 思う【おも・う】(u-verb) - to think
21. 預金者【よ・きん・しゃ】 - depositor
22. 大手【おお・て】 - large corporation
23. 銀行【ぎん・こう】 - bank
24. 相手【あい・て】 - other party
25. 取る【と・る】(u-verb) - to take
26. 訴訟【そ・しょう】 - litigation, lawsuit
27. 起こす【お・こす】(u-verb) - to cause, to wake someone
28. ケース - case
29. 出る【で・る】(ru-verb) - to come out
30. 金融庁【きん・ゆう・ちょう】 - Financial Services Agency
31. 被害者【ひ・がい・しゃ】 - victim
32. 救済【きゅう・さい】 - relief, aid
33. 優先【ゆう・せん】 - preference, priority, precedence
34. 金融【きん・ゆう】 - financing
35. 機関【き・かん】 - institution
36. 犯罪【はん・ざい】 - crime
37. 防止【ぼう・し】 - prevention
38. 強化【きょう・か】 - strengthen
39. 促す【うなが・す】(u-verb) - to urge
40. 判断【はん・だん】 - judgement, decision

41. 朝日 【あさ・ひ】 - Asahi
42. 新聞 【しん・ぶん】 - newspaper

「べき」 is a verb suffix used to describe something that is supposed to be done. This suffix is commonly defined as "should", however, one must realize that it cannot be used to make suggestions like the sentence, "You should go to the doctor." If you use 「べき」, it sounds more like, "You are supposed to go to the doctor." 「べき」 has a much stronger tone and makes you sound like a know-it-all telling people what to do. For making suggestions, it is customary to use the comparison 「方がいい」 grammar instead. For this reason, this grammar is almost never used to directly tell someone what to do. It is usually used in reference to oneself where you can be as bossy as you want or in a neutral context where circumstances dictate what is proper and what is not. One such example would be a sentence like, "We are supposed to raise our kids properly with a good education."

Unlike the 「はず」 grammar, there is no expectation that something is going to happen. Rather, this grammar describes what one should do in a given circumstance. In Japanese, you might define it as meaning 「絶対ではないが、強く推奨されている」.

There is very little of grammatical interest. 「べき」 works just like a regular noun and so you can conjugate it as 「べきじゃない」、「べきだった」, and so on. The only thing to note here is that when you're using it with 「する」, the verb meaning "to do", you can optionally drop the 「る」 from 「すべき」 to produce 「すべき」. You can do this with this verb only and it does not apply for any other verbs even if the verb is written as 「する」 such as 「擦る」, the verb meaning "to rub".

Using 「べき」 for actions that should be done

Attach 「べき」 to the action that should be done

Examples

1. 行う → 行うべき
2. する → するべき

For the generic "to do" verb 「する」 only, you can remove the 「る」

Example: する + べき → すべき

Examples

1. 何かを買う前に本当に必要かどうかをよく考えるべきだ。
Before buying something, one should think well on whether it's really necessary or not.
2. 例え国のためであっても、国民を騙すべきではないと思う。
Even if it is, for example, for the country, I don't think the country's citizens should be deceived.
3. 預金者が大手銀行を相手取って訴訟を起こすケースも出ており、金融庁は被害者の救

済を優先させて、金融機関に犯罪防止対策の強化を促すべきだと判断。（朝日新聞）
With cases coming out of depositors suing large banks, the Financial Services Agency decided it should prioritize relief for victims and urge banks to strengthen measures for crime prevention.

Using 「べく」 to describe what one tries to do

Vocabulary

1. 連用形 【れん・よう・けい】 - conjunctive form
2. 早い 【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
3. 帰る 【かえ・る】 (u-verb) - to go home
4. 準備 【じゅん・び】 - preparations
5. する (exception) - to do
6. 始める 【はじ・める】 (ru-verb) - to begin
7. 思う 【おも・う】 (u-verb) - to think
8. 出来る 【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
9. 行う 【おこな・う】 (u-verb) - to conduct, to carry out
10. 試験 【し・けん】 - exam
11. 合格 【ごう・かく】 - pass (as in an exam)
12. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
13. 一生懸命 【いっ・しょう・けん・めい】 - with utmost effort
14. 勉強 【べん・きょう】 - study
15. 今後 【こん・ご】 - from now on
16. お客様 【お・きゃく・さま】 - guest, customer
17. 対話 【たい・わ】 - interaction
18. 窓口 【まど・ぐち】 - teller window, counter; point of contact
19. より - more
20. 充実 【じゅう・じつ】 - fulfilled
21. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
22. 努力 【ど・りょく】 - effort
23. 参る 【まい・る】 (u-verb) - to go; to come (humble)

Grammatically, 「べく」 is really a conjunctive form (連用形) of 「べき」, similar to what the te-form does to connect another phrase. However, what needs mentioning here is that by changing it into a conjunctive and adding a predicate, the meaning of 「べく」 changes from the ordinary meaning of 「べき」. While 「べき」 describes a strong suggestion, changing it to 「べく」 allows you to describe what one did in order to carry out that suggestion. Take a look at the following examples to see how the meaning changes.

1. 早く帰るべき。
Should go home early.
2. 早く帰るべく、準備をし始めた。
In trying to go home early, started the preparations.

As we can see in this example, adding the 「準備をし始めた」 tells us what the subject did in order to carry out the action he/she was supposed to do. In this way we can define 「べく」 as meaning, "in order to" or "in an effort to". Similarly, 「べく」 might mean the Japanese equivalent of 「しようと思って」 or 「できるように」. This is a very seldom-used old-fashioned expression and is merely presented here to completely cover all aspects of 「べき」.

Using 「べく」 for actions that are attempted to be done

Attach 「べく」 to the action that is attempted to be done

Examples

1. 行う → 行うべく
2. する → するべく

Same as 「べき」, you can remove the 「る」 for the generic "to do" verb 「する」 only

Example: する + べく → すべく

Examples

1. 試験に合格すべく、皆一生懸命に勉強している。
Everybody is studying very hard in an effort to pass the exam.
2. 今後もお客様との対話の窓口として、より充実していくべく努力してまいります
We are working from here in an effort to provide a enriched window for customer interaction.

Using 「べからず」 to describe things one must not do

Vocabulary

- 未然形 【み・ぜん・けい】 - imperfective form
- 行う 【おこな・う】 (u-verb) - to conduct, to carry out
- する (exception) - to do
- ゴミ - garbage
- 捨てる 【す・てる】 (ru-verb) - to throw away
- 安全 【あん・ぜん】 - safety
- 措置 【そ・ち】 - measures
- 忘れる 【わす・れる】 (ru-verb) - to forget

Moving on to yet another form of 「べき」 is 「べからず」. This is undoubtedly related to the 「ず」 negative ending we learned in a previous section. However, it seems to be a conjugation of an old 未然形 of 「べから」. I have no idea what that means and you don't have to either. The only thing we need to take away from this is that 「べからず」 expresses the opposite meaning of 「べき」 as an action that one must **not** do. I suppose the short and abrupt ending of the 「ず」 form makes this more useful for laying out rules. In fact, searching around on google comes up with a bunch of 「べし・べからず」 or "do's and don'ts". (べし is an older form of べき, which I doubt you'll ever need.)

Using 「べからず」 for actions that must not be done

Attach 「べからず」 to the action that must not be done

Examples

1. 行う → 行う べからず
2. する → する べからず

Same as 「べき」, you can remove the 「る」 for the generic "to do" verb 「する」 only

Example: する + べからず → す べからず

Examples

1. ゴミ 捨てるべからず。
You must not throw away trash.
2. 安全措置を 忘れるべからず。
You must not forget the safety measures.

The minimum expectation

In this section, we'll learn various ways to express the minimum expectation. This grammar is not used as often as you might think as there are many situations where a simpler expression would sound more natural, but you should still become familiar with it.

Using 「(で)さえ」 to describe the minimum requirement

Vocabulary

1. 私【わたし】 - me; myself; I
2. 子供【こ・ども】 - child
3. 食べる【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
4. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
5. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
6. 読む【よ・む】 (u-verb) - to read
7. 宿題【しゅく・だい】 - homework
8. 多い【おお・い】 (i-adj) - numerous
9. トイレ - bathroom; toilet
10. 時間【じ・かん】 - time
11. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
12. お金【お・かね】 - money
13. 何【なに / なん】 - what
14. 出来る【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
15. お弁当【お・べん・とう】 - box lunch
16. 買う【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
17. あんた - you (slang)
18. 楽ちん【らく・ちん】 (na-adj) - easy
19. ビタミン - vitamin
20. 健康【けん・こう】 - health
21. 保証【ほ・しょう】 - guarantee
22. する (exception) - to do
23. 自分【じ・ぶん】 - oneself
24. 過ち【あやま・ち】 - fault, error
25. 認める【みと・める】 (ru-verb) - to recognize, to acknowledge
26. 問題【もん・だい】 - problem
27. 解決【かい・けつ】 - resolution
28. 教科書【きょう・か・しょ】 - textbook
29. もっと - more
30. ちゃんと - properly
31. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
32. 合格【ごう・かく】 - pass (as in an exam)
33. 一言【ひと・こと】 - a few words
34. くれる (ru-verb) - to give
35. こんな - this sort of
36. こと - event, matter
37. なる (u-verb) - to become

In English, we might say, "not even close" to show that not even the minimum expectation has been met. In Japanese, we can express this by attaching 「さえ」 to the object or verb that miserably failed to reach what one would consider to be a bare minimum requirement. Conversely, you can also

use the same grammar in a positive sense to express something is all you need.

Using 「(で)さえ」 to describe the minimum requirement

For nouns: Attach 「さえ」 or 「でさえ」 to the minimum requirement.

Examples

1. 私さえ - even me
2. 子供でさえ - even children

For verbs: Change the verb to the stem and attach 「さえ」. For verbs in te-form, attach 「さえ」 to 「て / で」.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べさえ
2. 行く → 行き → 行きさえ
3. 言ってくれる → 言ってさえくれる
4. 読んでいる → 読んでさえいる

Examples

1. 宿題が多すぎて、トイレに行く時間さえなかった。

There was so much homework, I didn't even have time to go to the bathroom.

2. お金さえあれば、何でも出来るよ。

The least you need is money and you can do anything.

3. お弁当を買うお金さえなかった。

I didn't even have money to buy lunch.

For nouns only, you can add 「で」 and use 「でさえ」 instead of just 「さえ」. There are no grammatical differences but it does sound a bit more emphatic.

1. 私でさえ出来れば、あんたには楽ちんでしょう。

If even I can do it, it should be a breeze for you.

You can also attach 「さえ」 to the stem of verbs to express a minimum action for a result. This is usually followed up immediately by 「する」 to show that the minimum action is done (or not). If the verb happens to be in a te-form, 「さえ」 can also be attached directly to the end of the 「て」 or 「で」 of the te-form.

1. ビタミンを食べさえすれば、健康が保証されますよ。

If you just eat vitamins, your health will be guaranteed.

2. 自分の過ちを認めさえしなければ、問題は解決しないよ。

The problem won't be solved if you don't even recognize your own mistake, you know.

3. 教科書をもっとちゃんと読んでさえいれば、合格できたのに。

If only I had read the textbook more properly, I could have passed.

4. 一言言っただけであればこんなことにならなかった。

If you only had said something things wouldn't have turned out like this.

「(で)すら」 - Older version of 「(で)さえ」

Vocabulary

1. 私【わたし】 - me; myself; I
2. 子供【こ・ども】 - child
3. この - this (abbr. of これの)
4. 天才【てん・さい】 - genius
5. 分かる【わ・かる】 (u-verb) - to understand
6. 緊張【きん・ちょう】 - nervousness
7. する (exception) - to do
8. ちらっと - a peek
9. 見る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
10. こと - event, matter
11. 出来る【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
12. 人【ひと】 - person
13. 漢字【かん・じ】 - Kanji
14. 知る【し・る】 (u-verb) - to know
15. 生徒【せい・と】 - student
16. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)

「(で)すら」 is a older variation of 「(で)さえ」 that is not as commonly used. It is essentially interchangeable with 「(で)さえ」 except that it is generally used only with nouns.

「(で)すら」 is used in the same way as 「(で)さえ」 for nouns

For nouns: Attach 「すら」 or 「ですら」 to the minimum requirement.

Examples

1. 私すら - Even me
2. 子供ですら - Even children

Examples

1. この天才の私ですらわからなかった。
Even a genius such as myself couldn't solve it.
2. 私は緊張しすぎて、ちらっと見ることすら出来ませんでした。
I was so nervous that I couldn't even take a quick peek.
3. 「人」の漢字すら知らない生徒は、いないでしょ！
There are no students that don't even know the 「人」 Kanji!

「おろか」 - It's not even worth considering

Vocabulary

1. 愚か 【おろ・ か】 (na-adj) - foolish
2. 漢字 【かん・ じ】 - Kanji
3. ひらがな - Hiragana
4. 読む 【よ・ む】 (u-verb) - to read
5. 結婚 【けっ・ こん】 - marriage
6. ～ヶ月 【～か・ げつ】 - counter for span of month(s)
7. 付き合う 【つ・ き・ あ・ う】 (u-verb) - to go out with; to accompany
8. 結局 【けっ・ きょく】 - eventually
9. 別れる 【わか・ れる】 (ru-verb) - to separate; to break up
10. 大学 【だい・ がく】 - college
11. 高校 【こう・ こう】 - high school
12. 卒業 【そつ・ ぎょう】 - graduate
13. する (exception) - to do

This grammar comes from the adjective 「愚か」 which means to be foolish or stupid. However, in this case, you're not making fun of something, rather by using 「おろか」, you can indicate that something is so ridiculous that it's not even worth considering. In English, we might say something like, "Are you kidding? I can't touch my knees much less do a full split!" In this example, the full split is so beyond the person's abilities that it would be foolish to even consider it.

Examples

1. 漢字は**おろか**、ひらがなさえ読めないよ！
Forget about Kanji, I can't even read Hiragana!
2. 結婚は**おろか**、2ヶ月付き合っ、結局別れてしまった。
We eventually broke up after going out two months much less get married.
3. 大学は**おろか**、高校すら卒業しなかった。
I didn't even graduate from high school much less college.

This grammar is rarely used and is primarily useful for JLPT level 1. The expression 「どころか」 is far more common and has a similar meaning. However, unlike 「おろか」 which is used as an adjective, 「どころか」 is attached directly to the noun, adjective, or verb.

1. 漢字**どころか**、ひらがなさえ読めないよ！
Forget about Kanji, I can't even read Hiragana!

Showing signs of something

In this lesson, we'll learn various expressions involving how to describe people who are expressing themselves without words. For example, we'll learn how to say expressions in Japanese such as "They acted as if they were saying goodbye," "He acted disgusted," and "She acts like she wants to go."

Showing outward signs of an emotion using 「～がる」

Vocabulary

1. 嫌【いや】 (na-adj) disagreeable; unpleasant
2. 怖い【こわ・い】 (i-adj) - scary
3. 嬉しい【うれ・しい】 (i-adj) - happy
4. 恥ずかしい【は・ずかしい】 (i-adj) - embarrassing
5. 早い【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
6. する (exception) - to do
7. 何【なに / なん】 - what
8. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
9. 彼女【かの・じょ】 - she; girlfriend
10. 朝【あさ】 - morning
11. 起こす【お・こす】 (u-verb) - to cause, to wake someone
12. タイプ - type
13. うち - referring to one's in-group, i.e. company, etc.
14. 子供【こ・ども】 - child
15. プール - pool
16. 入る【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter
17. 理由【り・ゆう】 - reason
18. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
19. 欲しい【ほ・しい】 (i-adj) - desirable
20. カレー - curry
21. 食べる【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
22. 家【1) うち; 2) いえ】 - 1) one's own home; 2) house
23. 帰る【かえ・る】 (u-verb) - to go home
24. すぐ - soon
25. パソコン - computer, PC
26. 使う【つか・う】 (u-verb) - to use
27. 皆【みんな】 - everybody
28. イタリア - Italy
29. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
30. 私【わたし】 - me, myself, I
31. 予算【よ・さん】 - budget
32. どう - how
33. とても - very
34. 怪しい【あや・しい】 (i-adj) - suspicious; dubious; doubtful
35. 妻【つま】 - wife
36. バッグ - bag
37. そんな - that sort of
38. もん - object (short for もの)
39. 買う【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
40. 訳【わけ】 - meaning; reason; can be deduced

- 41. 恥ずかしがり屋 【は・ ずかしがり・ や】 - one who easily feels or acts embarrassed
- 42. 寒がり屋 【さむ・ がり・ や】 - one who easily feels cold
- 43. 暑がり屋 【あつ・ がり・ や】 - one who easily feels hot
- 44. ミネソタ - Minnesota
- 45. 暮らす 【く・ らす】 (u-verb) - to live
- 46. 辛い 【つら・ い】 (i-adj) - harsh

The 「～がる」 grammar is used when you want to make an observation about how someone is feeling. This is simply an observation based on some type of sign(s). Therefore, you would not use it for your own emotions since guessing about your own emotions is not necessary. This grammar can only be used with adjectives so you can use this grammar to say, "He is acting scared," but you cannot say "He acted surprised," because "to be surprised" is a verb in Japanese and not an adjective. This grammar is also commonly used with a certain set of adjectives related to emotions such as: 「嫌」、「怖い」、「嬉しい」、or 「恥ずかしい」.

Using 「～がる」 for observing the emotions or feelings of others

- For i-adjectives:** Remove the last 「い」 from the i-adjective and then attach 「がる」
Example: 怖い → 怖がる
- For na-adjectives:** Attach 「がる」 to the end of the na-adjective
Example: 嫌 → 嫌がる

All adjectives that are conjugated with 「～がる」 become an u-verb

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	怖がる act scared	怖がらない not act scared
Past	怖がった acted scared	怖がらなかった didn't act scared

Examples

- 1. 早くきてよ！何を恥ずかしがっているの？
Hurry up and come here. What are you acting all embarrassed for?
- 2. 彼女は朝早く起こされるのを嫌がるタイプです。
My girlfriend is the type to show dislike towards getting woken up early in the morning.
- 3. うちの子供はプールに入るのを理由もなく怖がる。
Our child acts afraid about entering a pool without any reason.

This grammar is also used to observe very frankly on what you think someone other than yourself

wants. This involves the adjective 「欲しい」 for things one wants or the 「～たい」 conjugation for actions one wants to do, which is essentially a verb conjugated to an i-adjective. This type of grammar is more suited for things like narration in a story and is rarely used in this fashion for normal conversations because of its impersonal style of observation. For casual conversations, it is more common to use 「でしょう」 such as in, 「カレーを食べたいでしょう。」. For polite conversations, it is normal to not make any assumptions at all or to use the 「よね」 sentence ending such as in 「カレーを食べたいですか。」 or 「カレーを食べたいですよね。」

Examples

1. 家に帰ったら、すぐパソコンを使いたがる。
(He) soon acts like wanting to use computer as soon as (he) gets home.
2. みんなイタリアに行きたがってるんだけど、私の予算で行けるかどうかはとても怪しい。
Everybody is acting like they want to go to Italy but it's suspicious whether I can go or not going by my budget.
3. 妻はルイヴィトンのバッグを欲しがっているんだけど、そんなもん、買えるわけないでしょう！
My wife was showing signs of wanting a Louis Vuitton bag but there's no way I can buy something like that!

「～がる」 is also used with 「屋」 to indicate a type of person that often feels a certain way such as 「恥ずかしがり屋」 (one who easily feels or acts embarrassed)、 「寒がり屋」 (one who easily feels cold)、 or 「暑がり屋」 (one who easily feels hot).

- 私は寒がり屋だから、ミネソタで暮らすのは辛かった。
I'm the type who easily gets cold and so living in Minnesota was painful.

Using 「ばかり」 to act as if one might do something

Vocabulary

1. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
2. ボール - ball
3. 爆発【ばく・はつ】 - explosion
4. する (exception) - to do
5. 膨らむ【ふく・らむ】 (u-verb) - to expand; to swell
6. あんた - you (slang)
7. 関係【かん・けい】 - relation, relationship
8. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
9. 彼女【かの・じょ】 - she; girlfriend
10. 彼【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
11. 無視【む・し】 - ignore
12. 昨日【きのう】 - yesterday
13. 喧嘩【けん・か】 - quarrel
14. 何【なに / なん】 - what
15. 平気【へい・き】 (na-adj) - coolness; calmness
16. 顔【かお】 - face

We just learned how to observe the emotions and feelings of other by using 「～がる」 with adjectives. But what about verbs? Indeed, there is a separate grammar used to express the fact that someone else looks like they are about to do something but actually does not. Similar to the 「～がる」 grammar, this is usually not used in normal everyday conversations. I have seen it several times in books and novels but have yet to hear this grammar in a conversation.

For the regular non-past, non-negative verb, you must first conjugate the verb to the negative ending with 「ん」, which was covered here. Then, you just attach 「ばかり」 to the end of the verb. For all other conjugations, nothing else is necessary except to just add 「ばかり」 to the verb. The most common verb used with this grammar is 「言う」. It is also usually used with the 「に」 target particle attached to the end of 「ばかり」.

This grammar is completely different from the 「ばかり」 used to express amounts and the 「ばかり」 used to express the proximity of an action.

Using 「ばかり」 to indicate that one seems to want to do something

For present, non-negative: Conjugate the verb to the 「ん」 negative form and attach 「ばかり」

Example: 言う → 言わない → 言わん → 言わんばかり

For all other tenses: Attach 「ばかり」 to the end of the verb

Example: 言わなかった → 言わなかったばかり

Summary of basic conjugations

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	言わんばかり as if to say	言わないばかり as if [she] doesn't say
Past	言ったばかり as if [she] said	言わなかったばかり as if [she] didn't say

Examples

1. ボールは爆発せんばかりに、膨らんでいた。
The ball was expanding as if it was going to explode.
2. 「あんたとは関係ない」と言わんばかりに彼女は彼を無視していた。
She ignored him as if to say, "You have nothing to do with this."
3. 昨日の喧嘩で何も言わなかったばかりに、平気な顔をしている。
Has a calm face as if [he] didn't say anything during the fight yesterday.

Using 「めく」 to indicate an atmosphere of a state

Vocabulary

1. 謎【なぞ】 - puzzle
2. 秘密【ひ・みつ】 - secret
3. 皮肉【ひ・にく】 - irony
4. 紅葉【こう・よう】 - leaves changing color
5. 始まる【はじ・まる】 (u-verb) - to begin
6. すっかり - completely
7. 秋【あき】 - autumn
8. 空気【くう・き】 - air; atmosphere
9. なる (u-verb) - to become
10. そんな - that sort of
11. 顔【かお】 - face
12. する (exception) - to do
13. うまい (i-adj) - skillful; delicious
14. 説明【せつ・めい】 - explanation
15. 出来る【で・き・る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do
16. いつも - always
17. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
18. ～方【～かた】 - way of doing ～
19. 皆【みんな】 - everybody
20. 嫌【いや】 (na-adj) disagreeable; unpleasant

By now, you're probably thinking, "Ok, we've done adjectives and verbs. What about nouns?" As a matter of fact, there is a similar grammar that is used usually for nouns and na-adjectives. It is used to indicate that something is showing the signs of a certain state. Unlike the 「～がる」 grammar, there is no action that indicates anything; merely the atmosphere gives off the impression of the state. Just like the previous grammar we learned in this section, this grammar has a list of commonly used nouns such as 「謎」、 「秘密」、 or 「皮肉」. This grammar is used by simply attaching 「めく」 to the noun or na-adjective. The result then becomes a regular u-verb.

Using 「めく」 to indicate that one seems to want to do something

Attach 「めく」 to the noun or na-adjective. The result then becomes a regular u-verb.

Example: 謎 → 謎めく

Summary of basic conjugations

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	謎めく puzzling atmosphere	*謎めかない not puzzling atmosphere

Past	謎めいた puzzled atmosphere	*謎めかなかった not puzzled atmosphere
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*The negatives conjugations are theoretically possible but are not likely used. The most common usage is the past tense.

Examples

- 紅葉が始まり、すっかり秋めいた空気になってきた。
With the leaves starting to change color, the air came to become quite autumn like.
- そんな謎めいた顔をされても、うまく説明できないよ。
Even having that kind of puzzled look done to me, I can't explain it very well, you know.
- いつも皮肉めいた言い方をしたら、みんなを嫌がらせるよ。
You'll make everyone dislike you if you keep speaking with that ironic tone, you know.

For a whole slew of additional real world examples, check out the [jeKai entry](#). It states that the grammar can be used for adverbs and other parts of speech but none of the numerous examples show this and even assuming it's possible, it's probably not practiced in reality.

Expressing non-feasibility

We learned how to express feasibility in the section on the potential form quite a while ways back. In this section, we'll learn some advanced and specialized ways to express certain types of feasibility or the lack thereof. Like much of the grammar in the Advanced Section, the grammar covered here is mostly used for written works and rarely used in regular speech.

Expressing the inability to not do using 「～ざるを得ない」

Vocabulary

1. 得る 【え・る】 (ru-verb) - to obtain
2. 意図 【い・と】 - intention; aim; design
3. する (exception) - to do
4. 来る 【く・る】 (exception) - to come
5. 食べる 【た・べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
6. 行く 【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
7. この - this (abbr. of これの)
8. テレビ - TV, television
9. これ - this
10. 以上 【い・じょう】 - greater or equal
11. 壊れる 【こわ・れる】 (ru-verb) - to break
12. 新しい 【あた・らしい】 (i-adj) - new
13. 買う 【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
14. ずっと - the whole time, all along
15. 我慢 【が・まん】 - tolerance; self-control
16. 状態 【じょう・たい】 - situation
17. 歯医者 【は・い・しゃ】 - dentist
18. 上司 【じょう・し】 - superior; boss
19. 話 【はなし】 - story
20. 聞く 【き・く】 (u-verb) - to ask; to listen
21. どうしても - by any means, no matter what
22. 海外 【かい・がい】 - overseas

This grammar is used when there's something that just can't be helped and must be done. It is the negative version of the grammar we previously covered for something that has to be done. It uses the negative of the verb 「得る」 or "obtain", to roughly mean that "one cannot obtain not doing of an action". This means that you can't not do something even if you wanted to. As a result of the use of double negatives, this grammar carries a slight suggestion that you really don't want to do it, but you have to because it can't be helped. Really, the negative connotation is the only difference between this grammar and the grammar we covered in this "have to" section. That, and the fact that this grammar is fancier and more advanced.

This grammar uses an archaic negative form of verbs that ends in 「～ざる」. It is really not used in modern Japanese with the exception of this grammar and some expressions such as 「意図せざる」. The rules for conjugation are the same as the negative verbs, except this grammar attaches 「ざる」 instead. To reiterate, all you have to do is conjugate the verb to the negative form and then replace the 「ない」 with 「ざる」. The two exception verbs are 「する」 which becomes 「せざる」 and 「くる」 which becomes 「こざる」. Finally, all that's left to be done is to attach 「を得ない」 to the verb. It is also not uncommon to use Hiragana instead of the Kanji.

Using 「～ざるを得ない」 for actions that must be done

- To say that you can't not do something replace the 「ない」 part of the negative verb with 「ざる」, then attach 「を得ない」 to the end of the verb. Examples
 1. 食る → 食べない → 食べざる → 食べざるを得ない
 2. 行く → 行かない → 行かざる → 行かざるを得ない
- Exceptions:
 1. する → せざる → せざるをえない
 2. くる → こざる → こざるをえない

Examples

1. このテレビがこれ以上壊れたら、新しいのを買わざるを得ないな。 If this TV breaks even more, there's no choice but to buy a new one.
2. ずっと我慢してきたが、この状態だと歯医者さんに行かざるを得ない。 I tolerated it all this time but in this situation, I can't not go to the dentist.
3. 上司の話を聞くと、どうしても海外に出張をせざるを得ないようです。 Hearing the story from the boss, it seems like I can't not go on a business trip overseas no matter what.

Expressing the inability to stop doing something using 「やむを得ない」

Vocabulary

1. 止む 【や・ む】 (u-verb) - to stop
2. 仕方 【し・ かた】 - way, method
3. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
4. しょうがない - it can't be helped, nothing can be done
5. 得る 【え・ る】 (ru-verb) - to obtain
6. 事由 【じ・ ゆう】 - reason; cause
7. 手続 【て・ つづき】 - procedure, paperwork
8. 遅れる 【おく・ れる】 (ru-verb) - to be late
9. 必ず 【かなら・ ず】 - without exception, without fail
10. 連絡 【れん・ らく】 - contact
11. この - this (abbr. of これの)
12. 仕事 【し・ ごと】 - job
13. 厳しい 【きび・ しい】 (i-adj) - strict
14. 最近 【さい・ きん】 - recent; lately
15. 不景気 【ふ・ けい・ き】 - recession, depression
16. 新しい 【あた・ しい】 (i-adj) - new
17. 見つかる 【み・ つかる】 (u-verb) - to be found
18. 状態 【じょう・ たい】 - situation

This grammar is very similar to the one we just learned above except that it uses the verb 「止む」 to say that one cannot obtain the stopping of something. Remember that we normally can't just attach the 「を」 direct object particle to verbs, so this is really a set expression. Just like the previous grammar we learned, it is used to describe something that one is forced to do due to some circumstances. The difference here is that this is a complete phrase, which can be used for a general situation that doesn't involve any specific action. In other words, you're not actually forced to *do* something; rather it describes a situation that cannot be helped. If you have already learned 「仕方がない」 or 「しょうがない」, this grammar means pretty much the same thing. The difference lies in whether you want to say, "Looks like we're stuck" vs "Due to circumstances beyond our control..."

Since this is a set expression, there are really no grammar points to discuss. You only need to take the phrase and use it as you would any regular relative clause.

Examples

1. やむを得ない事由により手続が遅れた場合、必ずご連絡下さい。 If the paperwork should be late due to uncontrollable circumstance, please make sure to contact us.
2. この仕事は厳しいかもしれませんが、最近の不景気では新しい仕事が見つからないのでやむを得ない状態です。 This job may be bad but because (I) can't find a new job due to the recent economic downturn, it's a situation where nothing can be done.

Expressing what cannot be done with 「～かねる」

Vocabulary

1. かねる (ru-verb) - to be unable to; to find difficult (unpleasant, awkward, painful) to do;
2. 決める 【き・める】 (ru-verb) - to decide
3. する (exception) - to do
4. なる (u-verb) - to become
5. この - this (abbr. of これの)
6. 場 【ば】 - place, spot
7. ちょっと - a little
8. また - again
9. 別途 【べつ・と】 - separate
10. 会議 【かい・ぎ】 - meeting
11. 設ける 【もう・ける】 (ru-verb) - to establish
12. 個人 【こ・じん】 - personal
13. 情報 【じょう・ほう】 - information
14. 漏洩 【ろう・えい】 - disclosure; leakage
15. 速やか 【すみ・やか】 (na-adj) - speedy; prompt
16. 対応 【たい・おう】 - dealing with; support
17. 願う 【ねが・う】 (u-verb) - to wish; to request
18. 致す 【いた・す】 (u-verb) - to do (humble)

The meaning and usage of 「かねる」 is covered pretty well in this [jeKai entry](#) with plenty of examples. While much of this is a repetition of what's written there, 「かねる」 is a ru-verb that is used as a suffix to other verbs to express a person's inability, reluctance, or refusal to do something

「かねる」 is often used in the negative as 「かねない」 to indicate that there is a possibility that the verb in question might happen. As the jeKai entry mentions, this is usually in reference to something bad, which you might express in English as, "there is a risk that..." or "there is a fear that..."

One important thing that the jeKai doesn't mention is how you would go about using this grammar. It's not difficult and you may have already guessed from the example sentences that all you need to do is just attach 「かねる」 or 「かねない」 to the stem of the verb.

Using 「～かねる」 for things that cannot be done

- To say that something cannot be done using 「かねる」, change the verb to the stem and attach 「かねる」. Examples
 1. 決める → 決めかねる
 2. する → しかねる
- 「かねる」 is a ru-verb so use the negative 「かねない」 to say that something (bad) might happen. Examples

1. なる → なり かねる → なりかね ない
2. する → し かねる → しかね ない

Examples

1. この場ではちょっと 決めかねますので、また別途会議を設けましょう。 Since making a decision here is impossible, let's set up a separate meeting again.
2. このままでは、個人情報漏洩 しかねないので、速やかに対応をお願い致します。
At this rate, there is a possibility that personal information might leak so I request that this be dealt with promptly.

Tendencies

In this lesson, we will go over various types of grammar that deal with tendencies. Like much of the Advanced Section, all the grammar in this lesson are used mostly in written works and are generally not used in conversational Japanese.

Saying something is prone to occur using 「～がち」

Vocabulary

1. 見る【み・る】(ru-verb) - to see
2. なる(u-verb) - to become
3. 病気【びょう・き】 - disease; sickness
4. 確定【かく・てい】 - decision; settlement
5. 申告【しん・こく】 - report; statement; filing a return
6. 確定申告【かく・てい・しん・こく】 - final income tax return
7. 忘れる【わす・れる】(ru-verb) - to forget
8. 手続【て・つづき】 - procedure, paperwork
9. 留守【るす】 - being away from home
10. 家庭【か・てい】 - household
11. 犬【いぬ】 - dog
12. 猫【ねこ】 - cat
13. 勧め【すす・め】 - recommendation
14. 父親【ちち・おや】 - father
15. 皆【みんな】 - everybody
16. 心配【しん・ぱい】 - worry; concern
17. する(exception) - to do

This is arguably the most useful grammar in this lesson in terms of practically. By that, I mean that it's the only grammar here that you might actually hear in a regular conversation though again, it is far more common in a written context.

With this grammar, you can say that something is likely to occur by simply attaching 「がち」 to the stem of the verb. While, 「がち」 is a suffix, it works in much same way as a noun or na-adjective. In other words, the result becomes a description of something as being likely. This means that we can do things like modifying nouns by attaching 「な」 and other things we're used to doing with na-adjectives. You can also say that something is prone to *be* something by attaching 「がち」 to the noun.

As the word "prone" suggest, 「がち」 is usually used for tendencies that are bad or undesirable.

Using 「～がち」 as a description of an action prone to occur

- **For verbs:** Attach 「がち」 to the stem of the verb.

Examples

1. 見る → 見がち
2. なる → なり → なりがち

- **For nouns:** Attach 「がち」 to the appropriate noun

Example: 病気 → 病気がち

All adjectives that are conjugated with 「～がち」
become a noun/na-adjective

	Positive	Negative
Non-Past	なりがち prone to become	なりがちじゃない is not prone to become
Past	なりがちだった was prone to become	なりがちじゃなかった was not prone to become

Examples

1. 確定申告は**忘れがち**な手順のひとつだ。
Filing income taxes is one of those processes that one is prone to forget.
2. 留守**がち**なご家庭には、犬よりも、猫の方がおすすめです。
For families that tend to be away from home, cats are recommended over dogs.
3. 父親は病気**がち**で、みんなが心配している。
Father is prone to illness and everybody is worried.

For more examples, check out the [WWWJDIC examples](#).

Describing an ongoing occurrence using 「～つつ」

Vocabulary

1. テレビ - TV, television
2. 見る 【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
3. 寝る 【ね・る】 (ru-verb) - to sleep
4. 思う 【おも・う】 (u-verb) - to think
5. なる (u-verb) - to become
6. 二日酔い 【ふつ・か・よい】 - hangover
7. 痛む 【いた・む】 (u-verb) - to feel pain
8. 頭 【あたま】 - head
9. 押さえる 【おさ・える】 (ru-verb) - to hold something down; to grasp
10. トイレ - bathroom; toilet
11. 入る 【はい・る】 (u-verb) - to enter
12. 体 【からだ】 - body
13. いい (i-adj) - good
14. 最近 【さい・きん】 - recent; lately
15. 全然 【ぜん・ぜん】 - not at all (when used with negative)
16. 運動 【うん・どう】 - exercise
17. する (exception) - to do
18. 電気 【でん・き】 - electricity; (electric) light
19. 製品 【せい・ひん】 - manufactured goods, product
20. 発展 【はっ・てん】 - development; growth; advancement
21. つれる (ru-verb) - to lead
22. ハードディスク - hard disk
23. 容量 【よう・りょう】 - capacity
24. ますます - increasingly
25. 大きい 【おお・きい】 (i-adj) - big
26. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
27. 今 【いま】 - now
28. 日本 【に・ほん】 - Japan
29. 終身 【しゅう・しん】 - lifetime
30. 雇用 【こ・よう】 - employment
31. 年功 【ねん・こう】 - long service
32. 序列 【じょ・れつ】 - order
33. 年功序列 【ねん・こう・じょ・れつ】 - seniority system
34. 言う 【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
35. 慣行 【かん・こう】 - customary practice
36. 崩れる 【くず・れる】 (ru-verb) - to collapse; to crumble

「つつ」 is a verb modifier that can be attached to the stem of verbs to express an ongoing occurrence. Though the meaning stays essentially the same, there are essentially two ways to use this grammar. The first is almost identical to the 「～ながら」 grammar. You can use 「つつ」 to describe an action that is taking place while another action is ongoing. However, there are several

major differences between 「つつ」 and 「～ながら」. First, the tone of 「つつ」 is very different from that of 「～ながら」 and you would rarely, if ever, use it for regular everyday occurrences. To go along with this, 「つつ」 is more appropriate for more literary or abstract actions such as those involving emotions or thoughts. Second, 「～ながら」 is used to describe an auxiliary action that takes place while the main action is going on. However, with 「つつ」, both actions have equal weight.

For example, it would sound very strange to say the following.

- テレビを見つつ、寝ちゃダメよ！
(Sounds unnatural)
- テレビを見ながら、寝ちゃダメよ！
Don't watch TV while sleeping!

The second way to use this grammar is to express the existence of a continuing process by using 「ある」, the verb for existence. Everything is the same as before except that you attach 「ある」 to 「つつ」 to produce 「～つつある」. This is often used in magazine or newspaper articles to describe a certain trend or tide.

Using 「～つつ」 to describe a repetitive occurrence

- To describe an ongoing action, attach 「つつ」 to the stem of the verb.
Examples
 1. 見る → 見つつ
 2. 思う → 思い → 思いつつ
- To show the existence of a trend or tide, add 「ある」 to 「つつ」
Example: なる → なり → なりつつ → なりつつある

Examples

1. 二日酔いで痛む頭を押さえつつ、トイレに入った。
Went into the bathroom while holding an aching head from a hangover.
2. 体によくないと思いつつ、最近は全然運動してない。
While thinking it's bad for body, haven't exercised at all recently.
3. 電気製品の発展につれて、ハードディスクの容量はますます大きくなりつつある。
Lead by the advancement of electronic products, hard disk drive capacities are becoming ever larger.
4. 今の日本では、終身雇用や年功序列という雇用慣行が崩れつつある。
In today's Japan, hiring practices like life-time employment and age-based ranking are tending to break down.

For more examples, check out the [WWJDIC examples](#).

Describing a negative tendency using 「きらいがある」

Vocabulary

1. 嫌い 【きら・ い】 (na-adj) - distasteful, hateful
2. 依存症 【い・ ぞん・ しょう】 - dependence; addiction
3. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
4. 多い 【おお・ い】 (i-adj) - numerous
5. 大学生 【だい・ がく・ せい】 - college student
6. 締切日 【しめ・ きり・ び】 - closing day; deadline
7. ぎりぎり - at the last moment; just barely
8. 宿題 【しゅく・ だい】 - homework
9. やる (u-verb) - to do
10. コーディング - coding
11. 好き 【す・ き】 (na-adj) - likable; desirable
12. 開発者 【かい・ はつ・ しゃ】 - developer
13. ちゃんと - properly
14. する (exception) - to do
15. ドキュメント - document
16. 作成 【さく・ せい】 - creation
17. 十分 【じゅう・ ぶん】 - sufficient, adequate
18. テスト - test
19. 怠る 【おこた・ る】 (u-verb) - to shirk

「きらいがある」 is a fixed expression used to describe a bad tendency or habit. I suspect that 「きらい」 here *might* have something to do with the word for hateful: 「嫌い」. However, unlike 「嫌い」, which is a na-adjective, the 「きらい」 in this grammar functions as a noun. This is made plain by the fact that the 「が」 particle comes right after 「きらい」, which is not allowed for adjectives. The rest of the phrase is simply expressing the fact that the negative tendency exists.

Using 「きらいがある」 to describe a negative tendency

- The 「きらい」 in this grammar functions as a noun. 「ある」 is simply the existence verb for inanimate objects.
Example: 依存症 の きらいがある。

Examples

1. 多くの大学生は、締切日ぎりぎりまで、宿題をやらない きらいがある。
A lot of college students have a bad tendency of not doing their homework until just barely it's

due date.

2. コーディングが好きな開発者は、ちゃんとしたドキュメント作成と十分なテストを怠るきらいがある。

Developers that like coding have a bad tendency to neglect proper documents and adequate testing.

Advanced Volitional

We learned in a previous lesson that the volitional form is used when one is set out to do something. In this section, we're going to cover some other ways in which the volitional form is used, most notably, the negative volitional form.

Negative Volitional

Vocabulary

1. 見る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to see
2. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
3. する (exception) - to do
4. 来る 【く・ る】 (exception) - to come
5. なる (u-verb) - to become
6. 相手 【あい・ て】 - other party
7. 剣 【けん】 - sword
8. 達人 【たつ・ じん】 - master, expert
9. そう - (things are) that way
10. 簡単 【かん・ たん】 (na-adj) - simple
11. 勝つ 【か・ つ】 (u-verb) - to win
12. そんな - that sort of
13. 無茶 【む・ ちゃ】 - unreasonable; excessive
14. 手段 【しゅ・ だん】 - method
15. 認める 【みと・ める】 (ru-verb) - to recognize, to acknowledge
16. その - that (abbr. of *そのの*)
17. 時 【とき】 - time
18. 決して 【けっ・ して】 - by no means; decidedly
19. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
20. 会う 【あ・ う】 (u-verb) - to meet
21. 心 【こころ】 - heart; mind
22. 決める 【き・ める】 (ru-verb) - to decide
23. あの - that (over there) (abbr. of *あれの*)
24. 人 【ひと】 - person
25. ～度 【～ど】 - counter for number of times
26. 嘘 【うそ】 - lie
27. つく (u-verb) - to be attached
28. 誓う 【つか・ う】 (u-verb) - to swear, to pledge
29. 明日 【あした】 - tomorrow
30. やめる (ru-verb) - to stop; to quit
31. 肉 【にく】 - meat
32. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat

You may have seen the negative volitional form in a verb conjugation table and wondered, "What the heck is that used for?" Well the answer is not much, or to put it more accurately, there are various ways it can be used but almost all of them are extremely stiff and formal. In fact, it's so rare that I only found [one explanation](#) in English on the web or anywhere else. (I also found this [one](#) in Japanese.)

The negative volitional is used to express negative intention. This means that there is a will for something to **not** happen or that someone is set out to **not** do something. As a result, because one is trying not to do something, it's probably not going to happen. Essentially, it is a very stiff and formal

version of 「でしょう」 and 「だろう」. While this form is practically never used in daily conversations, you might still hear it in movies, etc.

Verbs are conjugated to the negative volitional by simply attaching 「まい」 to the verb. Another alternative is to attach 「まい」 to the stem. The conjugation for the negative volitional is quite different from those we are used to because it is always the last conjugation to apply even for the masu-form. There is no way to conjugate 「まい」 to the masu-form, you simply attach 「まい」 to the masu-form conjugation.

Using 「まい」 to express a will to not do something

- **For ru-verbs:** Attach 「まい」 to the stem.
Example: 見る → 見まい
- **For u-verbs:** Attach 「まい」 to the end of the verb
Example: 行く まい
- **Exceptions:**
 1. する → するまい or しまい
 2. くる → くるまい
- This conjugation must always come last. For masu-form, attach 「まい」 to the masu-form verb.
Example: なる → なり → なります → なりますまい

Examples

1. 相手は剣の達人だ。そう簡単には勝てまい。
Your opponent is a master of the sword. I doubt you can win so easily.
2. そんな無茶な手段は認めますまい！
I won't approve of such an unreasonable method !

We already learned that you could use the volitional form to say "let's" and to express an attempt do something. But that doesn't mean you can use the negative volitional to say "let's not" or "try not to". The tone of this grammar is one of very strong determination to not do something, as you can see in the following examples.

1. その時までは決して彼に会うまいと心に決めていた。
Until that time, I had decided in my heart to not meet him by any means.
2. あの人は、二度と嘘をつくまいと誓ったのです。
That person had sworn to never lie again.

In order to express "let's not", you can use the verb, 「やめる」 with the regular volitional. In order to express an effort to not do something, you can use 「ようにする」 with the negative verb.

1. 明日に行くのをやめよう。

Let's not go tomorrow. (lit: Let's quit going tomorrow.)

2. 肉を食べないようにしている。

Trying not to eat meat.

Using the volitional to express a lack of relation

Vocabulary

1. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
2. 行く 【い・ く】 (u-verb) - to go
3. あいつ - that guy (derogatory)
4. 大学 【だい・ がく】 - college
5. 入る 【はい・ る】 (u-verb) - to enter
6. 俺 【おれ】 - me; myself; I (masculine)
7. 関係 【かん・ けい】 - relation, relationship
8. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
9. 時間 【じ・ かん】 - time
10. 合う 【あ・ う】 (u-verb) - to match
11. 間に合う 【ま・ に・ あ・ う】 - to be in time
12. 最近 【さい・ きん】 - recent; lately
13. ウイルス - virus
14. 強力 【きょう・ りょく】 (na-adj) - powerful, strong
15. プログラム - program
16. 実行 【じっ・ こう】 - execute
17. する (exception) - to do
18. ページ - page
19. 見る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to see
20. 感染 【かん・ せん】 - infection

We will now learn a grammar that's actually practical for everyday use using the negative volitional grammar. Basically, we can use both volitional and negative volitional forms to say it doesn't matter whether something is going to happen or not. This is done by attaching 「が」 to both the volitional and the negative volitional form of the verb that doesn't matter.

Using the volitional to express a lack of relation

- Attach 「が」 to the volitional and negative volitional form of the verb.

Examples

1. 食べる → 食べよう、食べまい → 食べようが食べまいが
2. 行く → 行こう、行くまい → 行こうが行くまいが

Examples

1. あいつが大学に入ろうが入るまいが、俺とは関係ないよ。

Whether that guy is going to college or not, it has nothing to do with me.

2. 時間があろうがあるまいが、間に合わせるしかない。

Whether there is time or not, there's nothing to do but make it on time.

3. 最近のウィルスは強力で、プログラムを実行しようがしまいが、ページを見るだけで感染するらしい。

The viruses lately have been strong and whether you run a program or not, I hear it will spread just by looking at the page.

Using 「であろう」 to express likelihood

Vocabulary

1. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
2. 困難 【こん・なん】 (na-adj) - difficulty, distress
3. する (exception) - to do
4. 今後 【こん・ご】 - hereafter
5. ～年 【～ねん】 - counter for year
6. 人間 【にん・げん】 - human
7. 直面 【ちよく・めん】 - confrontation
8. 問題 【もん・だい】 - problem
9. 正面 【しょう・めん】 - front; facade
10. 向き合う 【む・き・あ・う】 (u-verb) - to face each other
11. 自ら 【みづか・ら】 - for one's self
12. 解決 【かい・けつ】 - resolution
13. はかる (u-verb) - to plan, to devise
14. その - that (abbr. of それの)
15. ノウハウ - know-how
16. 次 【つぎ】 - next
17. 産業 【さん・ぎょう】 - industry
18. なる (u-verb) - to become
19. シナリオ - scenario
20. 考える 【かんが・える】 (ru-verb) - to think
21. もちろん - of course
22. 生徒数 【せい・と・すう】 - number of students
23. 減少 【げん・しょう】 - decline, reduction
24. 現在 【げん・ざい】 - present time
25. 学科 【がっ・か】 - course of study
26. 新設 【しん・せつ】 - newly organized or established
27. 職業科 【しよく・ぎょう・か】 - occupational studies
28. 統廃合 【とう・はい・ごう】 - reorganization
29. 科内 【か・ない】 - within study course
30. コース - course
31. 改編 【かい・へん】 - reorganization
32. 時代 【じ・だい】 - period, era
33. 合う 【あ・う】 (u-verb) - to match
34. 変革 【へん・かく】 - reform
35. 求める 【もと・める】 (ru-verb) - to request; to seek

We already found out that the negative volitional can be used as kind of a formal version of 「でしょう」 and 「だろう」. You may wonder, how would you do the same thing for the volitional? The answer is to conjugate the verb 「ある」 from the formal state-of-being 「である」 to the volitional to produce 「であろう」. Remember 「でしょう」 can already be used as a polite form, so this form is even a step above that in formality. We'll see what kind of language uses this

form in the examples.

Using 「であろう」 to express likelihood

- Attach 「であろう」 to the noun, adjective, or verb.

Examples

1. 困難 → 困難であろう
2. する → するであろう

Examples

1. 今後50年、人間が直面するであろう問題に正面から向き合って、自ら解決をはかりつつ、そのノウハウが次の産業となるシナリオを考えたい。(from www.jkokuryo.com)

I would like to directly approach problems that humans have likely encounter the next 50 years and while devising solutions, take that knowledge and think about scenarios that will become the next industry.

2. もちろん、生徒数減少の現在、学科の新設は困難であろうが、職業科の統廃合や科内コースの改編などで時代に合わせた変革が求められているはずである。(from www1.normanet.ne.jp)

Of course, setting up new courses of study will likely be difficult with this period of decreasing student population but with reorganizations of occupational studies and courses within subjects, there is supposed to be demand for reform fit for this period.

Using 「かろう」 as volitional for 「い」 endings

Vocabulary

1. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
2. 早い【はや・い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
3. どんな - what kind of
4. 商品【しょう・ひん】 - product
5. ネット - net
6. 販売【はん・ばい】 - selling
7. 売上【うり・あげ】 - amount sold, sales
8. 伸びる【の・びる】 (ru-verb) - to extend, to lengthen
9. 言う【い・う】 (u-verb) - to say
10. 物【もの】 - object
11. 運動【うん・どう】 - exercise
12. 始める【はじ・める】 (ru-verb) - to begin
13. 遅い【おそ・い】 (i-adj) - late
14. 健康【けん・こう】 - health
15. いい (i-adj) - good
16. 変わる【か・わる】 (u-verb) - to change
17. 休日【きゅう・じつ】 - holiday, day off
18. この - this (abbr. of これの)
19. 関係【かん・けい】 - relation, relationship

We learned in the lesson about formal grammar that 「ではない」 was the negative of 「である」. So how would we say something like 「であろう」 but for the negative? The answer is to use yet another type of volitional for negatives and i-adjectives used only in formal and literary contexts. You can think of this grammar as a very old-fashioned version for i-adjectives and negative 「い」 endings.

The conjugation rule is simple: remove the last 「い」 and attach 「かろう」. You can use it for negatives and i-adjectives just like the 「かった」 past conjugation form.

Using 「かろう」 to express volition for 「い」 endings

- Drop the last 「い」 and attach 「かろう」

Examples

1. ではない ~~い~~ → ではな かろう
2. 早 ~~い~~ → 早 かろう

Examples

1. どんな商品でもネットで販売するだけで売上が伸びるというものではなかろう。
It's not necessarily the case that sales go up just by selling any type of product on the net.
2. 運動を始めるのが早かろうが遅かろうが、健康にいいというのは変わりません。
Whether you start exercising early or late, the fact that it's good for your health doesn't change.
3. 休日であろうが、なかろうが、この仕事では関係ないみたい。
Whether it's a holiday or not, it looks like it doesn't matter for this job.

Covered by something

This is a short lesson to cover several specialized expressions that describe the state of being covered by something. Mostly, we will focus on the differences between 「だらけ」、「まみれ」 and 「ずくめ」.

Using 「だらけ」 when an object is riddled everywhere with something

Vocabulary

1. 間違い【ま・ちが・い】 - mistake
2. ゴミ - garbage
3. 埃【ほこり】 - dust
4. この - this (abbr. of これの)
5. ドキュメント - document
6. 全然【ぜん・ぜん】 - not at all (when used with negative)
7. 役に立つ【やく・に・たつ】 (u-verb) - to be useful
8. 携帯【けい・たい】 - handheld (phone)
9. ～年【～ねん】 - counter for year
10. 使う【つか・う】 (u-verb) - to use
11. 傷【き・ず】 - injury; scratch; scrape
12. なる (u-verb) - to become
13. テレビ - TV, television
14. ちゃんと - properly
15. 拭く【ふ・く】 (u-verb) - to wipe; to dry
16. くれる (ru-verb) - to give

「だらけ」 is usually used when something is riddled everywhere. It generally carries a negative connotation. As a result, you'll often see 「だらけ」 used with expressions like 「間違いだらけ」, 「ゴミだらけ」, or 「埃だらけ」. There is no conjugation rule to cover here, all you need to do is attach 「だらけ」 to the noun that is just all over the place. You should treat the result just like you would a regular noun.

Using 「だらけ」 to describe the state of being riddled everywhere by something

- Attach 「だらけ」 to the noun that is covering the object or place

Examples

1. 間違い → 間違いだらけ (riddled with mistakes)
2. 埃 → 埃だらけ (riddled with dust)

Examples

1. このドキュメントは間違いだらけで、全然役に立たない。
This document is just riddled with mistakes and is not useful at all.
2. 携帯を2年間使ったら、傷だらけになった。

After using cell phone for 2 years, it became covered with scratches.

■ Notice how the 「の」 particle is used to modify since 「だらけ」 functions like a noun.

1. この埃だらけのテレビをちゃんと拭いてくれない？
Can you properly dust this TV completely covered in dust?

Using 「まみれ」 to describe a covering

Vocabulary

1. 間違い 【ま・ちが・い】 - mistake
2. 血 【ち】 - blood
3. 油 【あぶら】 - oil
4. ゴミ - garbage
5. 彼 【かれ】 - he; boyfriend
6. なる (u-verb) - to become
7. 車 【くるま】 - car
8. 修理 【しゅう・り】 - repair
9. 頑張る 【がん・ば・る】 (u-verb) - to try one's best
10. たった - only, merely
11. キロ - kilo
12. 走る 【はし・る】 (u-verb) - to run
13. 汗 【あせ】 - sweat
14. 情けない 【なさ・けない】 (i-adj) - shameful; deplorable

「まみれ」 may seem very similar to 「だらけ」 but there are some very important subtle differences. First, it's only used for actually physical objects so you can't say things like 「間違いまみれ」 like you can with 「だらけ」. Plus, you can only use it for things that literally cover the object. In other words, you can't use it to mean "littered" or "riddled" like we have done with 「だらけ」. So you can use it for things like liquids and dust, but you can't use it for things like scratches and garbage.

The grammatical rules are the same as 「だらけ」.

Using 「まみれ」 to describe a covering by sticking

- Like 「だらけ」, you attach 「まみれ」 to the noun that is doing covering.

Examples

1. 血 → 血まみれ (covered in blood)
2. 油 → 油まみれ (covered in oil)

- You can only use 「まみれ」 for physical objects that literally covers the object.

Examples

1. 間違いまみれ (not a physical object)
2. ゴミまみれ (doesn't actually cover anything)

Examples

1. 彼は油まみれになりながら、車の修理に頑張りました。
While becoming covered in oil, he worked hard at fixing the car.
2. たった 1 キロを走っただけで、汗まみれになるのは情けない。
It's pitiful that one gets covered in sweat from running just 1 kilometer.

「ずくめ」 to express entirety

Vocabulary

1. 黒【くろ】 - black
2. 白【しろ】 - white
3. いい (i-adj) - good
4. こと - event, matter
5. 団体【だん・たい】 - group
6. 去年【きょ・ねん】 - last year
7. ニュース - news
8. なる (u-verb) - to become
9. この - this (abbr. of これの)
10. シェーク - shake
11. おいしい (i-adj) - tasty
12. 栄養【えい・よう】 - nutrition
13. たっぷり - filled with
14. 体【からだ】 - body

The 「大辞林」 dictionary describes exactly what 「ずくめ」 means very well.

名詞およびそれに準ずる語句に付いて、何から何まで、そればかりであることを表す。すべて...である。

「うそ—の言いわけ」「いいこと—」「黒—の服装」「結構—」

In other words, 「ずくめ」 describes something that applies to the whole thing. For instance, if we were talking about the human body, the expression "is [X] from head to toe" might be close to what 「ずくめ」 means.

In actuality, 「ずくめ」 is an expression that is rarely used and usually with a color to describe people completely dressed in that color. For example, you can see what 「黒ずくめ」 looks like via [Google Images](#).

Grammatically, 「ずくめ」 works in exactly the same ways as 「だらけ」 and 「まみれ」.

Using 「ずくめ」 to describe something that applies to the whole thing

- Attach 「ずくめ」 to the noun that applies to the whole thing.

Examples

1. 白 → 白ずくめ
2. いいこと → いいことずくめ

Examples

1. 白づくめ団体は去年ニュースになっていた。

The organization dressed all in white was on the news last year.

2. このシェークは、おいしいし、栄養たっぷりで体にいいですから、いいことづくめですよ。

This shake is tasty and filled with nutrients, it's good for (your) body so it's entirely good things.

Immediate Events

In this section, we will be covering some advanced grammar that describe an action that takes place right after something else has occurred. I suggest you look over this section if you are really serious about completely mastering Japanese, or if you plan to take the level 1 JLPT exam, or if you enjoy reading a lot of Japanese literature.

Using 「が早いか」 to describe the instant something occurred

Vocabulary

1. 早い 【はや・ い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
2. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
3. 彼女 【かの・ じょ】 - she; girlfriend
4. 教授 【きょう・ じゅ】 - professor
5. 姿 【すがた】 - figure
6. 見る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to see
7. 教室 【きょう・ しつ】 - classroom
8. 逃げ出す 【に・ げ・ だ・ す】 (u-verb) - to run away
9. 食べる 【た・ べる】 (ru-verb) - to eat
10. 口 【くち】 - mouth
11. 中 【なか】 - inside
12. 放り込む 【ほう・ り・ こ・ む】 (u-verb) - to throw into

The phrase 「が早いか」 is used to describe something that happened the instant something else occurred. While very similar to the 「とたんに」 grammar, it has a strong emphasis on how soon one thing occurred after another as if it's almost simultaneous. This grammar is rarely used outside of Japanese language tests. To use this grammar, you attach 「が早いか」 to the first verb, then you describe the event that happened the next instant. While it's conventional to use the non-past tense (dictionary form) for the first verb, you can also use the past tense. For example, you can say either 「言うが早いか」 or 「言ったが早いか」. The curious thing about this grammar is that the 「が」 particle comes right after the verb. Remember, you can do this *only* with this specific grammatical phrase.

Using 「が早いか」 to describe what happened the instant something occurred

- Attach 「が早いか」 to the non-past or past tense of the verb that just occurred Examples
 1. 言う → 言うが早いか
 2. 言 → 言った → 言ったが早いか
- You can only use this grammar only for events that are directly related.
- You can only use this grammar only for events that actually happened (past tense).

Examples

1. 彼女は、教授の姿を見るが早いか、教室から逃げ出した。 The instant (she) saw the professor's figure, (she) ran away from the classroom.
2. 「食べてみよう」と言うが早いか、口の中に放り込んだ。 The instant (he) said "let's try

eating it", he threw (it) into his mouth.

3. 「食べてみよう」と言ったが早いか、口の中に放り込んだ。 The instant (he) said "let's try eating it", he threw (it) into his mouth.

Using 「や / や否や」 to describe what happened right after

Vocabulary

1. 早い 【はや・ い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
2. 否定 【ひ・ てい】 - denial
3. 見る 【み・ る】 (ru-verb) - to see
4. 私 【わたし】 - me, myself, I
5. 顔 【かお】 - face
6. 何 【なに / なん】 - what
7. 言う 【い・ う】 (u-verb) - to say
8. する (exception) - to do
9. 搭乗 【とう・ じょう】 - boarding
10. アナウンス - announcement
11. 聞こえる 【き・ こえる】 (ru-verb) - to be audible
12. 皆 【みんな】 - everybody
13. ゲート - gate
14. 方 【ほう】 - direction, way
15. 走り出す 【はし・ り・ だ・ す】 (u-verb) - to break into a run

The 「や」 or 「や否や」 (やいなや) phrase, when appended to a verb, is used to describe something that happened right after that verb. Its meaning is essentially the same as 「が早いか」. It is also another type of grammar that is not really used in regular conversational Japanese.

「否」 (read here as 「いな」) is a Kanji meaning "no" used in words like 「否定」. The literal meaning of this grammar is "whether the action was taken or not". In other words, the second action is taken before you even take the time to determine whether the first event really happened or not.

You can use this grammar by attaching 「や」 or 「や否や」 to the dictionary form of the first verb that occurred. Since this grammar is used for events that already have occurred, the second verb is usually in the past tense. However, you can use the dictionary tense to indicate that the events happen regularly.

Using 「や / や否や」 to describe what happened right after

- Attach 「や」 or 「や否や」 (やいなや) to the dictionary form of the first verb that occurred Examples
 1. 見る → 見るや
 2. 見る → 見るや否や
- This grammar is almost always used for events that actually happened (past tense).
- This grammar can be used with the present tense for regularly occurring events.

Examples

1. 私の顔を見るや、何か言おうとした。(He) tried to say something as soon as he saw my face.
2. 搭乗のアナウンスが聞こえるや否や、みんながゲートの方へ走り出した。As soon as the announcement to board was audible, everybody started running toward the gate.

Using 「そばから」 to describe an event that repeatedly occurs soon after

Vocabulary

1. 早い 【はや・ い】 (i-adj) - fast; early
2. 読む 【よ・ む】 (u-verb) - to read
3. する (exception) - to do
4. 子供 【こ・ ども】 - child
5. 掃除 【そう・ じ】 - cleaning
6. 散らかす 【ち・ らかす】 (u-verb) - to scatter around; to leave untidy
7. もう - already
8. あきらめる (ru-verb) - to give up
9. なる (u-verb) - to become
10. 教科書 【きょう・ か・ しょ】 - textbook
11. 忘れる 【わす・ れる】 (ru-verb) - to forget
12. 勉強 【べん・ きょう】 - study
13. 出来る 【で・ き・ る】 (ru-verb) - to be able to do

「そばから」 is yet another grammar that describes an event that happens right after another. However, unlike the expressions we have covered so far, 「そばから」 implies that the events are a recurring pattern. For example, you would use this grammar to express the fact that you just clean and clean your room only for it to get dirty again soon after. Besides this difference, the rules for using this expression are exactly the same as 「が早いか」 and 「や否や」. Just attach 「そばから」 to the dictionary form of the first verb that occurred. The past tense, though rare, also appears to be acceptable. However, the event that immediately follows is usually expressed with the non-past dictionary form because this grammar is used for repeated events and not a specific event in the past.

Using 「そばから」 to describe an event that repeatedly occurs soon after

- Attach 「そばから」 to the dictionary form of the first verb that occurred Examples
 1. 読む → 読む そばから
 2. する → する そばから
- This grammar implies that the events occur repeatedly.

Examples

1. 子供が掃除 するそばから 散らかすから、もうあきらめたくなった。 The child messes up (the room) [repeatedly] as soon as I clean so I already became wanting to give up.
2. 教科書を 読んだそばから 忘れてしまうので勉強ができない。 Forget [repeatedly] right

after I read the textbook so I can't study.

Other Grammar

Hopefully, you've managed to get a good grasp of how grammar works in Japanese and how to use them to communicate your thoughts in the Japanese way. In this final section, we'll be covering some left-over grammar that I couldn't fit into a larger category.

Using 「思いきや」 to describe something unexpected

Vocabulary

1. 思う 【おも・う】 (u-verb) - to think
2. ある (u-verb) - to exist (inanimate)
3. 昼間 【ひる・ま】 - daytime
4. 絶対 【ぜっ・たい】 (na-adj) - absolutely, unconditionally
5. 込む 【こ・む】 (u-verb) - to become crowded
6. 一人 【ひとり】 - 1 person; alone
7. いる (ru-verb) - to exist (animate)
8. この - this (abbr. of これの)
9. レストラン - restaurant
10. 安い 【やす・い】 (i-adj) - cheap
11. 会計 【かい・けい】 - accountant; bill
12. 千円 【せん・えん】 - 1,000 yen
13. 以上 【い・じょう】 - greater or equal

This is a grammar I learned out of a book and was surprised to actually hear it used in real life on a number of occasions. You use this grammar when you think one thing, but much to your astonishment, things actually turn out to be very different. You use it in the same way as you would express any thoughts, by using the quotation 「と」 and 「思う」. The only difference is that you use 「思いきや」 instead of 「思う」. There is no tense in 「思いきや」, or rather, since the results already went against your expectations, the original thought is implicitly understood to be past tense.

Using 「思いきや」 to describe something unforeseen or unexpected

- Attach 「思いきや」 to the thought using the quotation 「と」. Example: ある → あると → あると思いきや

Examples

1. 昼間だから絶対込んでいると思いきや、一人もいなかった。 Despite having thought that it must be crowded since it was afternoon, (surprisingly) not a single person was there.
2. このレストランは安いと思いきや、会計は5千円以上だった！ Thought this restaurant would be cheap but (surprisingly) the bill was over 5,000 yen!

Using 「～がてら」 to do two things at one time

Vocabulary

1. 散歩【さん・ぽ】 - walk, stroll
2. 作る【つく・る】 (u-verb) - to make
3. タバコ - tobacco; cigarettes
4. 買う【か・う】 (u-verb) - to buy
5. 行く【い・く】 (u-verb) - to go
6. 博物館【はく・ぶつ・かん】 - museum
7. 見る【み・る】 (ru-verb) - to see
8. お土産【お・みやげ】 - souvenir
9. つもり - intention, plan

This rather formal and seldom-used grammar is used to indicate that two actions were done at the same time. The nuance is a bit different from 「ながら」 in that some or all of the time spent on doing one action was also used to do another action as an aside. Remember, 「ながら」 is used to describe two exactly concurrent actions. The interesting thing about this grammar is that no verb is required. You can just attach it to a noun, and the verb "to do" is inferred. For instance, "while taking a stroll" can simply be expressed as 「散歩がてら」. In the case where you want to employ a different verb, you also have the option of attaching 「がてら」 to the stem similar to the 「ながら」 usage. In addition, the verb or noun that is accompanied by 「がてら」 is the main action while the following action is the one done on the side.

Using 「～がてら」 to do two things at one time

- Attach 「がてら」 to the noun or verb stem of the main action. In case of a noun, the verb 「する」 is inferred. Examples
 1. 散歩 → 散歩がてら
 2. 作る → 作り → 作りがてら

Examples

1. 散歩がてら、タバコを買いに行きました。 While taking a stroll, I also used that time to buy cigarettes.
2. 博物館を見がてらに、お土産をかうつもりです。 While seeing the museum, I plan to also use that time to buy souvenirs.

Using 「～あげく（挙句）」 to describe a bad result

Vocabulary

1. 挙句 【あげ・く】 - in the end (after a long process); at last
2. 喧嘩 【けん・か】 - quarrel
3. 考える 【かんが・える】 (ru-verb) - to think
4. 事情 【じ・じょう】 - circumstances
5. ～時間 【～じ・かん】 - counter for span of hours
6. 掛ける 【か・ける】 (ru-verb) - to hang; to take (time, money)
7. 説明 【せつ・めい】 - explanation
8. する (exception) - to do
9. 納得 【なつ・とく】 - understanding; agreement
10. もらう (u-verb) - to receive
11. 先生 【せん・せい】 - teacher
12. 相談 【そう・だん】 - consultation
13. 退学 【たい・がく】 - dropping out of school
14. こと - event, matter

「あげく」 is a grammar used to describe a result, usually negative, that came about after a great deal of effort. The rule for this grammar is very simple. You modify the verb or noun that was carried out with 「あげく」 and then describe the final result that came about from that verb or noun. Because this grammar is used to describe a result from an action already completed, it is used with the past tense of the verb. 「あげく」 is essentially treated the same as any noun. In other words, you would need the 「の」 particle to modify another noun. 「あげくの果て」 is another stronger version of this grammar.

Using 「～あげく」 to describe a final result

- Attach 「あげく」 to the verb or noun that created the end result (「の」 particle is required for nouns) Examples
 1. けんか → けんか のあげく
 2. 考えた → 考えた あげく

Examples

1. 事情を2時間かけて説明したあげく、納得してもらえなかった。(After a great deal of explaining the circumstances for 2 hours, (in the end), couldn't receive understanding.
2. 先生と相談のあげく、退学をしないことにした。(After much) consulting with teacher, (in the end), decided on not dropping out of school.

